

FOR AGENTS, EDITORS AND PRODUCERS

This is the pitch, not the brochure. The world's full secret stays hidden until you choose to reveal it.

Working copy: dashed boxes mark what is still to be decided. Switch to the buyer view to see the deck as an agent or editor will.

01 · The hook

UNITARIA



If you had everything
you ever wanted, would
you still want the truth?

In a world where phones have become LiFE wristbands that know everything about you before you do, Ro's has never found her passion. Named the last Golden Prospect of the jubilee year, she glitches the Compass live in front of millions and becomes the most-watched mystery at the most-watched school in the world. She has one year to prove there's something inside her. But the system can't actually see her, and finding out why could cost her the only place she's ever belonged.

BOOK ONE: TO DECIDE BOOK ONE TITLE

Series title: TO DECIDE Series title (Unitaria?)

Unitaria is not “the future”. It’s our world, if our culture had fifty more years to evolve.

Not futuristic dystopia plus magic school plus reality show. A recognisable civilisation where all of those things have naturally evolved out of our culture.

The Academy

~~HOGWARTS~~

Oxford + Stanford + the Olympics + TikTok + a royal institution + reality television + the world’s most prestigious university.

The Houses

~~HOGWARTS HOUSES~~

College sports teams + Greek life + fandom + varsity culture + social identity.

The Exhibition

~~A DYSTOPIAN DEATH TOURNAMENT~~

The Olympics + Eurovision + a World’s Fair + America’s Got Talent + university admissions + the Met Gala + reality TV.

The Director

~~A DICTATOR~~

A head of state who is also the world's biggest celebrity. Nobody thinks "God, I hate him." They think "OH MY GOD, THE DIRECTOR IS HERE."

The LiFE Band

~~A SURVEILLANCE ANKLE MONITOR~~

Apple Watch + the TikTok algorithm + Spotify Wrapped + Google Maps + LinkedIn + Duolingo + your entire digital identity. You wear it voluntarily. You like it. It tells you "You're doing great." Until one day: wait, who taught it what great means?

The Points

~~PRISON POINTS~~

Loyalty points + university applications + social credit + gamification + Uber ratings + achievement badges. People compete for them and show them off: "She's got 14,000 points, babe, obviously she's getting into Neuropa."

*Technology doesn't remove silliness.
It gives silliness a production budget.*

PICTURE IT

The Director isn't in a dark throne room. He's walking through the Academy in sunglasses, in something insanely expensive but somehow effortless. His band flashes, the cameras turn, someone screams "DIRECTOR!" He laughs and waves, the snow leopard mascot appears behind him, and the whole stadium erupts while millions watch at home. Somewhere beneath all of it is a truth that could destroy everything he's built.

That juxtaposition is the whole book.

FIRST, READERS WANT IT

THEN

I'd love to go to the Academy.

I want to know my house.

I want the band.

I want to meet the Director.

I want to be a Fellow.

Gradually: oh. Oh no. I actually understand why everyone stays.

So the world is never obviously sinister. The romance is romantic, the houses are genuinely exciting, the Exhibition is genuinely spectacular, and Unitaria is genuinely better than our world in some ways. When the cracks appear, the reader doesn't think "get out!" They think "but I don't want this world to disappear either."

The reader has to answer the same question as the characters, and stops watching Unitaria. They're implicated in it.

What it feels like to live there.

YOUR LIFE BAND TODAY

- 07:00 The under-16s daily drop is live.
Community tasks near you.
- 08:15 Your one automatic task today: the
community kitchen.
- 12:30 1,000 points unlocks Italian week on your
family menu.
- 17:45 Recalibrate beta: find the underlying
issues and tackle them with clarity.
- 21:00 You're doing great.

TRAILBLAZERS, THIS IS YOUR HOUSE

I'M AN ORION.

THE MASCOT

Ori, in an absurdly expensive arena suit, cannonballing onto the stage to music and pyrotechnics. He has his own social account, and nobody knows who's inside.

THE RIVALS

Lyra, bold against gentle. Polaris, doers against thinkers.

THE ALUMNI

Leaders, explorers, Restoration Corp commanders and Persovia's space pioneers.

THE KIT

Onyx black hoodies and jackets with flecks of gold, Ori plushies, belt-star pins.

THE LEGENDS

The Ascent, a race up the outside of the Academy's tower. The Climb, the bell rung at midnight by every new member.

POLARIS

WAYFINDERS · ARIS THE HUSKY

"Curious and wise, the ultimate sleuth, / Polaris is the true guiding star of the truth!"

AURORA

DAWNCHASERS · AURA THE FOX,
WITH A LIGHT-UP TAIL

"Cunning like a fox, the spark and the flame, / Aurora's the wildfire nobody can tame!"

LYRA

SONGKEEPERS · LYR THE SWAN

"Loyal and relentless, united here we stand, / Lyra holds the world in the palm of their hands!"

ORION

TRAILBLAZERS · ORI THE SNOW
LEOPARD

"Bold, daring and fearless are we, / Orion pushes further than the eye can see!"

Every mascot is a full arena suit, with its own social account. Ori is the most famous of all.

2077. Fifty years after the Great Reconnecting.

Our world, fused into one landmass within living memory. Familiar, but not where it's supposed to be.

The Academy



The seat of government and the world's favourite television show share one name, so criticising one feels like attacking the other.

The Exhibition



The world's grand celebration of youth, born of the Director's love of the old World's Fairs and London's Great Exhibition of 1851. Eleven weeks, ten realms, one Grand Final, and every sixteen-year-old receives an offer.

The Realms



One landmass, three Continents, ten realms. Every culture on every doorstep.

The LiFE Band



The Points



Realignment and Rehoming



Your life on your wrist, with no screens. It projects your day, your tasks and your points, and it knows you.

Money is gone. Every right is free, and points reward doing good.

A fresh start somewhere that truly speaks to your soul. Rehoming is always a choice.

Everything works.

THE UTOPIA IS REAL.

No grey dystopia, no starving districts, no obvious tyrant. Every right is free:

A home

Good food

Clothing

Healthcare

Learning

Travel

A living wage in any career

THE CONTROL IS REAL TOO.

Control through comfort, not force. Every gift has a cost.

No money; points for doing good

Goodness becomes a performance and a leaderboard

The band: convenience, no screens

Constant surveillance, emotional nudging, and Recalibrate coming

The School of Life: find your passion

Your whole childhood is the exam, and the data decides your path

Rehoming is always a choice

Choice architecture: nudged by points, stigma and recommendations

Thanksmas gratitude and lanterns

Grateful people don't ask who caused it

A humble Director who offers to step down

A cult of devotion that keeps him there

The first story belongs to one girl. The universe doesn't.

Ro

HER NAME

Ro, short for Rosalia. She hates her full name, and nobody uses it except the Director, who always calls her Rosalia.

HER FAMILY

Nonna, who remembers the world before. A mum who knows the family safe exists and has no interest in what's inside. A younger brother. A dad who is mostly absent, because he works for the Director and is one of the Seven. Grandpapa Harry died recently.

HER PLACE IN THE SYSTEM

She tried every single job, not to get ahead but to find a passion, and without realising racked up a ridiculous number of points. The

WHO

Sixteen in 2077, born in 2061, after the world was remade. She lives on the crescents in Neuropa, the capital.

HER WOUND

Everyone around her seems so happy and content, except her. Parentified by an absent dad and a checked-out mum, she wonders whether she isn't just unhappy, but bad.

WHAT MAKES HER DIFFERENT

Her band was quietly altered by Harry, so it lags and can't read her excitement. The system that serves everyone their passion can't see hers. When she touches the golden Compass, it goes haywire

girl with no passion is chosen as one of the forty Golden Prospects of the Grand Academy.

HER DANGER

Her readings are normal. Her curiosity is not.

THE PEOPLE AROUND HER

Mum: . Dad: .
Brother: . Best friends: Nell (Renella) and Sam (Samson, always Sammy to her). Chosen family: .

THE CHOICE SHE HAS TO MAKE

Book One

WHERE IT OPENS

The end of August 2076, just before her Academy year begins, with the reveal that her points are the fourth highest in the realm: the last of the four places, so the girl with no passion only just makes it in.

THE THREAT, HIDDEN AS AN ADVERT

for one second, live, in front of the world. It has never happened before.

HER HOUSE

THE ROMANCE

Team Spark or Team Anchor, both genuinely right for her. The Spark is Jase, her Orion nemesis, who meets the girl she is becoming and makes her feel alive. The Anchor is Sam, her oldest friend, who knew her before she had to prove herself and makes her feel known.

THE CLOCK

The Academy year from September 2076, then eleven weeks of Exhibition season from the 50th Reconnection Day on 7 May 2077, her dad's fiftieth birthday. The book ends during the Grand Final.

THE CLIMAX

Recalibrate, a gentle mood-ring update, is announced in passing at the start. It quietly adds mapping and location sharing.

Recalibrate rolls out to every band at once during the Grand Final, at the moment her difference is most likely to be exposed.

THE STRUCTURE

TO DECIDE Book One structure

THE ENDING

TO DECIDE Book One ending

THE FEELING ON THE LAST PAGE

Enraged, awakened, needing to know more, satisfied but shaken, and "it's ON."

Open any part of the system.

Each one is what the world believes, and what is actually underneath.

The Academy



WHAT EVERYONE KNOWS

Where the world is governed and the Academy year is broadcast. One guaranteed year of education for every sixteen-year-old.

WHAT'S UNDERNEATH

The greatest show on Earth, designed by a man who understands branding better than anyone alive. Bread and circuses, with houses and merch.

The Houses



WHAT EVERYONE KNOWS

Polaris, Aurora, Lyra and Orion: the Academy's four rules for the whole world, chosen by the Compass.

WHAT'S UNDERNEATH

Teams to root for and a show nobody can stop watching. The institution decides your direction.

The Exhibition



WHAT EVERYONE KNOWS

The World's Fairs, brought back. "Only this time, there would be no nations. There would be children." A celebration of youth that finds every child's potential.

The LiFE Band



WHAT EVERYONE KNOWS

Convenience, no screens, a life assistant that knows you.

WHAT'S UNDERNEATH

WHAT'S UNDERNEATH

A festival that hardened into a judgement in 2051, and a hunt for the young genius who can cure what no one can name.

Secretly a radiation exposure meter, like a nuclear worker's dosimeter: a number, not a diagnosis. And surveillance built in.

The Points



WHAT EVERYONE KNOWS

No money, no fines. Every right free; points for doing good.

WHAT'S UNDERNEATH

The basics are grey, and colour, flavour and wonder are paid upgrades. The economy parentifies children by design.

Realignment



WHAT EVERYONE KNOWS

Compassion, not prison: help for people who are unhappy with their circumstances.

WHAT'S UNDERNEATH

People whose readings climb too high are quietly removed to Isola, where new fixes are tested on them.

Rehoming



WHAT EVERYONE KNOWS

A permanent fresh start in the realm that suits your soul. Always a choice.

WHAT'S UNDERNEATH

Those who respond well are returned to a different realm, so they never tell loved ones anything strange. Nobody seems to come home.

The Director



WHAT EVERYONE KNOWS

The humble, beloved leader who keeps offering to step down.

WHAT'S UNDERNEATH

The keeper of the noble lie, sitting on top of the very company that broke the world.

Seven eras, from the world before to the jubilee.

01

BEFORE 2027

The world before

Our world. Nonna is born in 1994; the Director in 2006, heir to a global defence company.

02

7 MAY 2027

The event

The Great Reconnecting. The Shake, the Drift and the Settling fuse the continents into one land.

03

2027 TO 2032

The immediate aftermath

Around eighty per cent of the world is lost. Also: community, purpose, belonging and duty.

04

THE REBUILD YEARS

The rebuild

Armies become the Restoration Corp. The world refuses to go "back to normal".

05

THE NEW ORDER

Realms, councils, Director

The public cries out for a leader like him. He offers to lead "while

06

2032 TO 2051

The new systems

Money abolished, then collapsed. Points, bands and the School of Life by about 2035. The first

the world finds its feet".

Exhibition in 2037; the first "full"
one in 2051.

07

2077

The present day

The golden jubilee. Fifty years
reconnected.

But this is only the history the world remembers.

The Secret

The world was told an undersea climate
catastrophe beyond human control nearly ended
everything, and that humanity survived thanks to
a divine fix.

What happened

The Director's family's defence company ran an
AI-controlled weapons test that went rogue,
detonating two enormous bombs under the
ocean on opposite sides of the globe.

The two scars

Isola, cleaned up for show and used for
Realignment. Trovata, the still-contaminated

How it held

Severed undersea cables meant nobody could
compare notes. The family company controlled

second blast site, where the people who knew too much were sent.

what was measured. Scientists who suspected were absorbed, dismissed or moved away.

BENEDICT REVERINGTON

The biggest celebrity on Earth, and the man everyone thinks they know.

DIRECTOR SIGHTINGS

He's doing his community task in Shangokyo today.

ACADEMY NETWORK

Director spotted at the Academy.

OUTFIT BREAKDOWNS

Is that the jacket from the 2059 Exhibition?

REACTION ACCOUNT

He offered to resign again. The public said no.

01

Heir

Born 2006 into an old-money family whose defence company had its hands in everything. He despised the establishment behind his own name.

02

Survivor

Twenty-one at the Reconnecting. His father died in it.

03

The world's darling

He had been speaking out about the old system failing. When the dust settled, the public cried out for a leader like him.

04

05

06

Reformer

He abolished money, built the points, and created the Exhibition out of his love of the World's Fairs. He actually does a good job.

Director

Seventy-one in 2077. Humble, cheeky, sometimes too honest, and always ready to hand over the reins. The people won't let him.

The turn

He starts hiding the damage the illnesses do, and chooses to let people suffer rather than tell the truth. Bit by bit, until his own sister disappears.

FROM THE DECISION LOG: BE (BEFORE EVIL) AND PE (POST EVIL)

Naming the show and the seat of government The Academy	BE
Abolishing money, then introducing the points system	BE
The first Exhibition, from his love of World's Fairs (2037)	BE
Exiling truth-tellers to Trovata	PE
His sister's disappearance	PE
Recalibrate and its location sharing	PE

His story exists before hers.

The Director's prequel, in the spirit of The Ballad of Songbirds and Snakes:

TO DECIDE Prequel logline

Nonna (real name: TO DECIDE Nonna's real name))

BEFORE

Born 1994. Left Italy for the UK at seven, where she met Harry, her lifelong best friend. A few months into a job as PA to the Director's father.

DURING

As it happened, the father asked her to back everything up. He died; his directive stayed with her, on an old hard drive. Soon after, she found out she was four months pregnant.

AFTER

Presumed dead, she took a new identity, deactivated her band and wore it as a ruse. A sweet old Nonna, hiding in plain sight in the Director's own city.

NOW

She nags about recipes and hums the kneading song: "palms up and down, round and round." The way she kneads dough is the way you unlock the family safe.

Her story is another doorway into the same secret.

Young Nonna and Harry's love story through the end of the world, told partly through her journal.

They were born with the new world, on 7
May 2027.

Orphaned as babies, they were raised by the
Academy, part wards, part siblings, part
inner circle.

Now they are fifty, living symbols at the
centre of the jubilee.

And one of them is her father.

Every story reveals another piece of the same world.



The Director

The origin of his villain arc, as The Ballad of Songbirds and Snakes is for Snow.

TO DECIDE GENRE



Nonna and Harry

A love story through the end of the world, partly told through her journal.

TO DECIDE GENRE



The Seven

Seven lives, seven stories. Not all of them are loyal.

TO DECIDE GENRE



Isola

Every character's island journey is its own story, made for an anthology.

ANTHOLOGY



Harry

Never fully explained, on purpose. A black box.

KEPT A MYSTERY



Trovata

TO DECIDE Trovata as a story

TO DECIDE GENRE



The first Exhibition

TO DECIDE

The 2037 Exhibition as a story

TO DECIDE GENRE



The missing sister

Mentioned only in passing, like a name on a family tapestry. Readers will theorise for years.

TO DECIDE GENRE

NOTHING IS INCIDENTAL.

A secret code runs through everything from the first page. Casual fans get Easter eggs, hardcore fans get ciphers, and nobody needs to solve anything to enjoy the story.

FIRST READ

Nonna nags about recipes: "One of these days these recipes are going to be the most valuable thing you own, my girl."

LATER

It turns out to be literally true.

FIRST READ

A lullaby about kneading dough.

LATER

The movements open the family safe.

FIRST READ

Polaris's motto, "Seek, and you shall find."

LATER

The first line of Nonna's lullaby.

FIRST READ

Orion's hidden wall of names, for those who dared too far.

LATER

Those weren't heroic deaths.

FIRST READ

FIRST READ

Rehoming: lovely, compassionate social mobility.

LATER

Why do people never seem to come home?

Nonna's diary, sold as a cheap stocking filler.

LATER

A cipher manual for instalments still to come.

The first story contains the clues to stories that haven't happened yet.

Where the trail ends: TO DECIDE The cipher's final reveal





UNITARIA

Books

The main series

The Director's prequel

Nonna's journal,
published as a real in-
world book

TO DECIDE

Number of books in
the main series

Screen

Shot in real places,
bent through colour,
light and practical
effects, so fans can
visit

TO DECIDE

TV or film plan

Interactive

The Compass quiz: find
your house (live on the
site)

An in-world LiFE beta
advert that doubles as
the newsletter sign-up

The long cipher, from
the first page

TO DECIDE Game

Things to hold

House hoodies, pins
and mascots

The kneading song, a
real song like "The
Hanging Tree"

TO DECIDE

Merch range

Places

Harry's clubhouse as a
walk-through attraction

Real filming locations

TO DECIDE

Theme park

*None of it is required to understand Book One. The universe rewards
obsession; it never demands homework.*

She is the perfect way in.

- ✦ Nonna remembers the world before. Her mum stays silent. She inherits a world she never saw being made.
- ✦ She lives inside the world's greatest success story, and she is the one who can't understand why everyone else seems so happy.
- ✦ In a world of manufactured contentment, her discontent is the alarm. What looks like dysfunction may be accurate perception.
- ✦ Her arc runs from "everyone is happy but me" to "nobody actually is."

WHERE IT SITS

The Hunger Games asks what happens when entertainment becomes violence. *Unitaria* asks what happens when entertainment becomes governance.

Black Mirror asks what technology reveals about us. *Unitaria* asks what happens when technology makes a genuinely better world, and therefore makes giving it up almost impossible.

Comparable titles:

TO DECIDE Comps

THIS IS ONLY THE BEGINNING.

1994 · 2027 · 2077 · ?

The world existed before her. It will continue after her.

FOR KATEY

Still to decide

Every dashed box in this deck, in the order it appears, plus the gaps behind them.

☐ Book One title

☐ Her house

☐ Dad's name

☐ Her chosen family

☐ Book One structure

☐ Prequel logline

☐ Trovata as a story

☐ The cipher's final reveal

☐ TV or film plan

☐ Merch range

☐ Series title (Unitaria?)

☐ Mum's name

☐ Brother's name

☐ Her choice in Book One

☐ Book One ending

☐ Nonna's real name

☐ The 2037 Exhibition as a story

☐ Number of books in the main series

☐ Game

☐ Theme park

☐ Comps

☐ The Spin-off Bench (Module 9 not started)

☐ The cipher's final reveal

☐ The illnesses' official name

☐ A genre for each companion story

☐ The Launch (Module 14 not started)

☐ The company's name, old and new



UNITARIA

One world. Ten realms. Fifty years reconnected.

HOME

THE WORLD

THE REALMS

THE ACADEMY

THE HOUSES

THE LIFE BAND

LIFE IN UNITARIA

THE FELLOWS

THE COMPASS



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